

SUPRANATIONAL FEDERALISM

The World Citizens' Journal

For a dialogue between peoples, nations and civilizations



**THE ALTIERO SPINELLI INSTITUTE
FOR FEDERALIST STUDIES**

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"It's good to live where humanity reigns. Those who choose to reside in a place devoid of humanity lack wisdom. ... Do not do to others what you would not want them to do to you." (Confucius, *The Analects*, 4.1; 15.24).

Nowadays young people wonder if they will have a future. A nuclear war between great powers can annihilate the population of entire continents. Moreover, all living organisms, including humanity, are threatened by an irreversible ecological crisis of the biosphere. The international political system created at the end of the Second World War is paralyzed by hostilities between large and small powers pursuing conflicting goals and interests. No world player proposes to stop the mad race towards a fatal international anarchy.

However, the federalists can act. About half of the world's population lives in federal states, but in these countries, federalism is conceived as a technique of administrative decentralization. On the contrary, in Europe, since the Schuman Declaration of 1950, the European Coal and Steel Community (ECSC) has been conceived as "the first step towards the European Federation." European and world federalists can act together for a just and peaceful international order, founded on democratically legitimized supranational institutions.

International pacification is necessary to stop the environmental crisis, the arms race and war. The first step is to start a dialogue between all national peoples and civilizations on the future of the international order. The European Union, "by creating an area of freedom, security and justice," has established the European citizenship. Why not establish the same form of peaceful coexistence for the citizens of the world?

Submissions – The "Supranational Federalism" Journal is open to all citizens of the world who wish to develop arguments and observations on the international political process in the spirit indicated in the mission statement above. The contribution must be written in English. The Journal will be published every three months. Each contribution must not exceed the limit of 1,500 words and must be sent to the following address: supranational.federalism@gmail.com. We encourage young people to submit articles. Submission must include a short biography and a photo of the author. Please do not include footnotes, endnotes, or references; instead provide hyperlinks for any references you think would be helpful. We reserve the right to make editorial changes before publication.

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The figure on the front page - with twelve portraits that have been chosen as personalities who have indicated to future generations the founding values of a cosmopolitan civilization - is the work of the graphic designer Alice Lazzaro: alicelazzaroart@gmail.com

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The Agony of International Law

Andersen tells in a fairy tale that an emperor exclaims to wear wonderful clothes woven by some tricksters who say they made them in such a way that fools cannot see them. When the king comes out in his new clothes in the procession everyone applauds, but a child exclaims "the king is naked" and so the deception is revealed. The same thing is happening for international law in world politics, especially since the advent of Trump as president of the United States, although the decline of traditional international law began at the end of the Cold War, when the so-called US monopolar order was established. It was an order similar to the king's dress because it allowed micro-nationalistic conflicts to break out on every continent. The situation worsened in 2022, with Russia's invasion of Ukraine (not a "war", which would have provoked a position taken by the Security Council, but "a special military operation"). Shortly thereafter, the conflict between Israel and Hamas in Palestine involved all the countries of the Middle East. Many innocent Palestinians were slaughtered, without the perpetrators being punished. As soon as he was re-elected, Trump violated international free trade agreements by imposing high tariffs on all countries exporting to the United States. The military intrusion in Venezuela would demonstrate, according to Trump, that only the US, not the ICC, is capable of ensuring international justice. The United Nations, founded to ensure a peaceful and secure world, is now considered by Trump to be an obstacle to his imperial policies. The "Board of Peace" should not only deal with the pacification of the Middle East, but also to "supervise" the UN.

The international order is not based on law, but on power. The post-war order was decided in 1945, in Yalta, by the United States and the Soviet Union, with the intermediation of Great Britain. In 1944, the Bretton Woods conference had already established the rules for the creation of a free world market. The United Nations has succeeded in guaranteeing world peace thanks to the determination of the two superpowers to require all governments to respect the Yalta Pact. Within the two imperial areas, each superpower could intervene in cases where a country questioned the hegemony of the superpower: in the East it happened with the suppression of the rebel governments of Budapest (1956) and Prague (1968). The United States favored the fall of the Allende government in Chile in 1973. It should be noted, however, that the bipolar US-USSR government favoured the process of decolonisation, as demonstrated by the joint intervention of the two superpowers in the Suez crisis of 1956, to prevent France and Great Britain from regaining political and commercial control of the canal. After Suez, the process of decolonization accelerated, especially in Africa and Asia. Thanks to the hegemony of the two superpowers, the whole world, with the exception of a few countries of the so-called Third World, has been able to enjoy relative economic progress, a gradual reduction in income gaps between industrialized and emerging countries and an international peace not interrupted by continuous threats of wars, conventional or nuclear (despite the episode of the US-USSR conflict over Soviet missiles in Cuba). The breakup of the Soviet Union allowed for an illusory phase of U.S. unipolarity soon followed by conflicts, civil wars, and wars between states on every continent.

Today, there are no longer superpowers, only big and medium powers. The Russian war in Ukraine and the election of Trump have made it clear that the world is on its way to a multipolar system of imperial areas. The Russian Tsar wants to rebuild the nineteenth-century Euro-Asian empire. The U.S. government has acknowledged, as Barack Obama had already done, that the U.S. no longer has the necessary strength to intervene in the many conflicts that erupt on every continent: it must focus on its vital interests. Trump is implementing a regional imperialist policy, drastically reducing European commitments, but preserving the fundamental alliance with Israel to maintain his grip on the Middle East and the Mediterranean. In Asia, the growing power of China, rightly considered the third world power, is asserting itself, waiting for India and Brazil to join the leading group. China's economic and political rise is being opposed by Trump, who fears China for its growing economic, technological, and military potential.

In this context, we must ask ourselves whether the ambition of the great powers to conquer states and regions to be governed by imperial procedures can lead humanity towards lasting peace. The answer to this question is negative, for two reasons. The first is that, despite the division of the world into imperial areas, international economic interdependence has now reached lasting dimensions, difficult to attack by modern protectionism. In the years between the two world wars, national protectionism fostered the arms race. Today, the arms race is taking place in an increasingly interconnected economic and technological context, because the basis of technological progress is science organized on a planetary basis (think of CERN in Geneva, the discovery of the Higgs boson, quantum mechanics, space exploration). In these regions, despite the contrasts between powers, scientific collaboration continues without borders and international economic sanctions are easily circumvented. The struggle between empires could cause the collapse of economic-scientific cooperation, with dramatic consequences.

The second reason for the inherent madness contained in the imperial multipolar order is nuclear proliferation. According to a statement by a US Secretary of Defense: "Mr Trump has the absolute authority to start a nuclear war. Without minutes, the president could unleash the equivalent of more than 10.000 Hiroshima bombs. He does not need a second option ... Yet it would mean the end of civilization as we know it" ([M. Baradei, Project Syndicate, Dec. 25, 2025](#)). It is useful to remember that Russia has about 5,500 nuclear warheads, the USA more than 5,000, France 300 and other countries, such as Israel, India, Pakistan, etc., a smaller amount, but still enough to destroy entire regions. Nuclear proliferation is ongoing. All governments, even those that call themselves peace-loving, such as the Europeans, are investing more and more national resources in armaments. If we add to nuclear proliferation the use of AI as an automatic response system – because only a few seconds are allowed for a response to a danger signal – we must conclude that contemporary international politics is leading humanity towards nuclear catastrophe. Until a few years ago, the MAD (Mutual Assured Destruction) thesis was supported as a rule of prudence for the use of nuclear war. Today, the MAD strategy is outdated. A preemptive strike is convenient to destroy an entire continent with a massive nuclear broadside in order to avoid a possible enemy response. Is this the civilization that humanity is building in the twenty-first century?

Today, young people are fascinated by the rapid advancement of information technologies and the achievements of extra-terrestrial space. The moon is considered as a necessary stage for the colonization of Mars. But who will prevent the possible nuclear catastrophe on Earth? Will humanity have a future? What political force considers humanity as a political subject, a community of destiny, life on Earth as a common good? These are questions that should be tried to be answered.

European and world federalists can engage in a constructive dialogue to find an answer to these dilemmas, provided that we abandon the myth that international law, as it is currently conceived, can lead us to nuclear disarmament and universal peace. It is power that creates law, not law that creates power: this is why national and supranational constitutions are needed to avoid absolute power in states and between states. War between sovereign states must become impossible and will become so when states decide to put their sovereign powers on national armaments to a supranational government, entrusting the power to settle disputes between states to the International Court of Justice (currently without powers) which will thus be able to impose compliance with its sentences thanks to a supranational military force (the reinforced blue helmets) under a world federal government. This is the path suggested by Einstein back in 1947, because nuclear war does not admit intermediate solutions. The king is naked. It must be dressed in federalist clothes visible to the foolish national governments that are still ignorant of the dangers of a nuclear and ecological catastrophe.

Who Governs Sovereignty?

by Atunde Ahmed Olarewaju

The policies of Washington since the resumption of President Trump in the white house have challenged the sovereignty in new and inexplicable ways. The detention of Nicolas Maduro and the further spreading of unilateral pressure into the Global South are signals of the high diplomatic tension. They highlight a bigger change in international politics. Sovereignty, which has been so far, at least formally, by multilateral rules, is growing under the influence of the strategic decisions of the powerful states. Today, in the international relationship sphere, the power of a state to act is more important than institutional processes enshrined under international laws.

For African governments, this shift feels familiar. The concern is not about defending particular regimes. It is about precedent. If the detention of a sitting head of state can be justified after the fact, and if entire regions can be subjected to travel restrictions and sanctions without collective deliberation, then sovereignty becomes conditional. Protection depends less on law than on alignment.

Africa has long navigated this terrain. In northern Nigeria, recent U.S. airstrikes were framed in Washington as a moral intervention against religious violence. Yet Nigeria's security crisis is complex, shaped by insurgency, organised crime, climate stress and regional instability. By simplifying it into a single narrative, the intervention reinforced a troubling pattern: African crises can be defined externally and acted upon first, with legitimacy claimed later. The issue is not only intervention. It is authorship. Who gets to define Africa's emergencies?

This question reaches beyond Africa. The renewed debate in Washington over Greenland — a self-governing territory within the Kingdom of Denmark — unsettled European capitals precisely because it echoed the same logic. Territory was discussed in strategic and transactional terms, as an asset to be secured rather than a community whose sovereignty is anchored in democratic consent. Though Greenland is not Africa, the underlying message was similar: sovereignty can be recalibrated if strategic interest demands it.

Yet Europe and Africa have not always related to each other through such transactional logic. There was a time when the relationship between the two continents rested on structured political dialogue. Under the Lomé Convention, African parliamentarians and Members of the European Parliament met regularly within a joint assembly framework. Those encounters did not erase inequalities in trade or development, but they created a space for representatives of European and African citizens to debate shared priorities. The relationship was not purely governmental; it was parliamentary. It is assumed that legitimacy flows from citizens and that cross-continental cooperation requires political conversation, not only executive negotiation.

In many ways, that model reflected a quiet federal instinct. Not federalism in the sense of merging states, but federalism as a philosophy of shared sovereignty — different political communities retaining autonomy while pooling authority where mutual interest demands it. It recognised that cooperation between unequal partners requires institutionalised dialogue, predictable rules, and a recognition that sovereignty is layered, not absolute.

That spirit has thinned. Today, the EU-AU relationship is often mediated through security coordination, migration management and development funding frameworks that are negotiated largely at the executive level. Parliamentary engagement exists, but it no longer defines the tone of the partnership. At the same time, other global actors are increasingly willing to deploy military support in Africa to secure influence, sometimes bolstering authoritarian regimes in exchange for strategic access.

The danger is not only external interference. It is the erosion of the very idea that sovereignty should be governed through rules rather than leverage. Some African governments have responded

assertively. Mali, Burkina Faso and Niger have rejected what they perceive as coercive Western measures, arguing that partnerships cannot depend on submission to foreign political priorities. Their choices are controversial and deeply debated within Africa itself. But their actions reflect a broader impulse: reclaiming ownership over how sovereignty is exercised and negotiated.

Other states have chosen quieter recalibration. Even where cooperation with Western partners continues, the language of unquestioned partnership has given way to more cautious assessments of dependence. African policymakers increasingly speak not only about alignment, but about diversification — building multiple channels of engagement in a multipolar world.

For Europe, this moment carries a particular weight. The European Union is itself a federal experiment, a political project built on pooling sovereignty to prevent conflict and create shared prosperity. Its legitimacy rests on the belief that law, institutions and democratic representation can tame power. If that belief is diluted globally, Europe's own narrative weakens.

This is why the memory of Lomé matters. It reminds both continents that their relationship once aspired to something more than stability or resource management. It sought a common understanding between European and African citizens through their representatives. It treated development not merely as aid, but as a political dialogue about justice, trade and social transformation.

Rebuilding that spirit does not mean replicating past frameworks. The world is more multipolar and more contested than in the era of Lomé. But it does mean recognising that economic and democratic development require peaceful and predictable relations between governments, relations anchored in fairness rather than force.

If sovereignty today risks becoming a variable shaped by great-power competition, Europe and Africa could instead choose to model a different approach: structured cooperation rooted in democratic institutions, transparent negotiation and shared responsibility. That would mean strengthening parliamentary exchanges, investing in African-led security mechanisms, and designing development policies that prioritise social justice and local ownership over short-term strategic gain. From Caracas to Greenland, the temptation to treat sovereignty as negotiable is growing. Africa is responding by asserting greater agency over how its crises are defined and managed. Europe must now decide whether it will relate to Africa as a strategic arena or as a political partner.

The choice is not only about influence. It is about the future character of the global order. In a world where power increasingly overrides process, Europe and Africa have an opportunity to revive a federal instinct: shared sovereignty governed by law, dialogue and mutual accountability. The question is no longer who is strong enough to act. It is those who are willing to build rules strong enough to endure.



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Professor Sachs on the Future of the United Nations

by Hemachandra Basappa

According to Professor Jeffrey Sachs, - in his speech at the Security Council of the U.N. (January 5th, 2026) - the world is still stunned by the military action that the US has taken in kidnapping the President of Venezuela and his wife. The US President has taken unilateral action, without his own country's Congress, who can authorise such an action, in total violation of the UN Charter.

However, one needs to reflect on the past action by other US Presidents, as they intervened in country after country, either for a regime change, which did not suit them or for the natural resources of that nation. As Professor Jeffrey Sachs stated in his statement to the UN Security Council, that the US has intervened in 70 countries between 1947 to 1989.

To achieve their objectives, " they have instigated unrest, support for armed groups, manipulation of mass and social media, bribing of military and civilian officials, targeted assassinations, economic warfare, which are illegal under the UN Charter and results in ongoing violence, lethal conflict, political instability and deep suffering of the civil population ". It would appear that when all these attempts fail, the US imposes sanctions. It is reported that when the US imposed sanctions on Venezuela on the export of their oil, their GDP fell by 62 % and in 2019, their assets outside the country of about 7 billion were frozen.

Prof Sachs stated that in the past year, the US has taken action on Iran, Iraq, Somalia, Nigeria, Syria, Yemen and now in Venezuela. The US President has also called on Canada to become the 51st State of the USA. More recently he has been speaking about Greenland becoming part of the US - which he claims is their legitimate right for their security.

Unfortunately, as most countries export to the US, they are either afraid to speak out for consequences on their trade with the US or they do not care at what is happening. European leaders are still stuck in the 'cold war ' mind set and they expect to be overrun by Russia. This thinking does not allow them to take a stand on what just happened, when the duly elected President of a UN member State and his wife are kidnapped and taken to a jail in the US and accused of all kinds of crimes. What the European Nations seem to forget is, with the disintegration of the Warsaw Pact, the Soviet Union broke up into 23 independent countries, Yugoslavia also broke up, along with Czechoslovakia and Germany was unified. People's freedom and aspirations cannot be curtailed for too long. There are some problems in two or three European Nations, but they prefer to stay united in spite of their differences and languages.

The US President has also stated that a large quantity of Venezuelan oil will go to the US and he will control the way that country runs. What happens to the people of Venezuela? For how long will they suffer and be in a state of indifference? What will be the consequence on the rest of the world, directly or indirectly on this emerging situation?

US interference elsewhere has more or less destroyed these Nations. In Vietnam, Cambodia and Laos, the unexploded bombs and other munition and chemicals left behind from the Vietnam war, still harms people in those countries. Every now and then we hear and read about children who have been maimed and injured by these bombs. How large stretches of the countryside is potentially dangerous for agriculture and for people to move around.

Sanctions which the US forces through the UN Security Council wipes away generations of people in the countries on which they are imposed. The tariff that the US imposes on countries around the world is most damaging and dangerous to the people in those countries - where decades of development are just wiped out. The unilateral decision of the US President in withdrawing from as many as 51 UN specialised agencies, will set back the world and the US by decades. The funds, which the US is expected to provide as their share to the UN too will dry up.

Prof Sachs has called on the UNSC to depute a representative to report on the situation in Venezuela within 14 days. He ended his presentation by saying: "Peace and survival of humanity depends on whether the UN Charter remains a living instrument of International law or allowed to weather away into irrelevance, that is the choice before this council today."

Since this briefing to the UN SC, by Professor Sachs, much has happened. And the world continues to watch as the US forcefully goes on to overlook the UN and the UNSC and repeatedly makes statements detrimental to world peace and security.



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European Union, What Do We Want?

by Pier Virgilio Dastoli

At the outset of a new phase in the process of regional integration involving a significant part of the European continent, in a world marked by devastating crises, by the evaporation of multilateralism and by a rival bipolarism between the United States and China, each with its own junior partners, the European Union (EU) must ask itself what the prospects are for its international positioning.

It must ask whether the conditions exist to move from the status of a collective junior partner of the United States towards a gradual prospect of equal political, economic, financial, technological and industrial partnership, within the framework of a shared European sovereignty, as suggested rather by the objectives than by the instruments set out in the Draghi Report.

The upheavals and devastation currently affecting the international system in fact compel the EU to rewrite its international positioning across all dimensions: democratic, political, economic, social, security-related, environmental and cultural.

The hope is that the EU will be able to do better than in the past and will be capable of opening a new phase of relations with the (Global) South, bearing in mind that the challenge for the EU is finally to take into account the expectations of these countries, which account for 20% of global GDP, particularly with regard to poverty reduction, which has declined in India and China but increased in the rest of these countries, as well as sustainable development and environmental protection.

The EU must update its relations with all the countries that are generically placed within the framework of the Global South by reorganising its external economic policy and its trade policy, bearing in mind that the growth of trade produces positive environmental effects in areas integrated into the global economy if they are equipped with policies that internalise in prices the cost of using environmental resources, but produces negative effects otherwise, with a deterioration of environmental conditions through excessive use of natural resources, air and water pollution, an increase in waste, and land degradation.

The entire planet has been affected by processes which, in an increasingly interdependent manner and at growing speed, have called into question the geopolitical order and intensified social imbalances, as shown by the contrast between the reduction of extreme poverty in part of the so-called Global South and its exponential growth, especially in sub-Saharan Africa.

These interdependent processes, not governed by supranational authorities, are causing devastation even in the most advanced democracies on the planet and, more broadly, a crisis of democracy, which has often given way to autocracies.

The crises have produced both horizontal and vertical inequalities, to which European policies have not provided adequate responses.

In this context, the documents approved by the 2024 Summit of the Future, convened in New York on 22-23 September 2024, should be taken up by the European Union as an opportunity to reaffirm its commitment to peace, justice, the fight against climate change and inequalities, and the overcoming of the crisis of multilateralism.

While the world is gripped by a dramatic military escalation, on 22 September 2024 the United Nations General Assembly approved by consensus the Pact for the Future, together with the Global Digital Compact and the Declaration for Future Generations.

Compared with the 2030 Agenda, the Pact, together with the two complementary texts, includes issues that had been discussed for years without results:

- the issue of multilateral governance, with particular reference to the role of the Security Council, its representativeness, its effectiveness and its relations with the General Assembly;
- the less than wholehearted commitment to the reduction of nuclear weapons together with the phasing out of lethal military technologies;
- the idea of reforming the international financial architecture, starting with the IMF and the World Bank, together with the role of the WTO;
- the issue of national public debt and a minimum level of global taxation;
- the use of new digital technologies for all;
- the participation of young people in decision-making processes within the United Nations framework.

For my part, I wish to draw attention to some troubling silences and to put forward a proposal at the level of the European Union as it prepares to set its priorities for the 2024-2029 legislative term.

The first deafening silence concerns the issue of democracy – or rather, the global decline of democracy and the rise of authoritarianism – as an essential condition for the establishment of a new system of global governance.

This includes, *inter alia*, the defence of press freedom, which is not even mentioned in the Digital Compact; the independence of the judiciary and the principles of representative democracy in electoral processes; the fight against disinformation and external interference; violations of political rights; and forms of repression directed at organisations representing civil society. Within this context also lies the absence of instruments for the creation of a genuine international public sphere, capable of going beyond the current system whereby non-governmental organisations are recognised by the United Nations.

The second silence concerns the issue of ethical finance as a tool for achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, which require a strong public–private partnership as defined by the seventeenth SDG (Sustainable Development Goals).

The issue of finance is linked to the reform of international organisations and implicitly raises the alternative between, on the one hand, the creation of a global currency detached from any relationship with a state issuing authority and placed under the control of a suitably renewed and strengthened IMF, and, on the other hand, the establishment of an international basket currency, following a path similar to that which led from the European Monetary System (EMS) to the euro, while leaving open the question of reforming the Special Drawing Rights established in 1969 in order to identify an instrument of international liquidity alternative to the dollar.

The third silence concerns the commitment to stay the course – or to consider the Paris Climate Agreement as the compass – for the achievement of all the objectives of the 2030 Agenda within the terms and timelines agreed almost ten years ago, objectives that are now being questioned and opposed, as evidenced by the ongoing dismantling action within the European Union on issues such as deforestation and clean transport by those who seek to revise decisions already taken or to bring forward their review.

The fourth deafening silence concerns migration policies – whose causes and effects are closely intertwined with issues of peace, security, sustainable development, youth and future generations – which are increasingly subjected to a broad securitarian approach based on national closures that undermine international solidarity, fundamental rights and the principles of free movement. This occurs in clear contradiction with the demographic crisis and the ageing of populations in developed countries, but also with the substantial decline in unlawful entries in 2024 (down by 39% in the European Union alone).

The Pact ignores another UN pact, namely the one on safe, orderly and regular migration approved by 162 United Nations Member States in Marrakech on 10 December 2018 as a follow-up to the 2016 New York Declaration for Refugees and Migrants, and subsequently formally adopted by 152 members of the United Nations General Assembly in New York on 19 December 2018.

In order to respond to US protectionism, aggressive Russian nationalism, the transformation of the global power network and Chinese economic neo-colonialism, the reopening of the European project therefore appears necessary, so as to equip the European Union with the powers and instruments indispensable to play an autonomous role as a global actor and to launch a new cycle in the governance of interdependence, marked by balanced and sustainable development, détente and respect for human dignity.

European policies will have to be consistent with the objectives of the United Nations 2030 Agenda, which represents a programme for an orderly model of global governance aimed at achieving the seventeen Sustainable Development Goals.

All these issues should form part of the strategic priorities that the European Union ought to place on the agenda of a Conference on Security and Cooperation in Europe (Helsinki II), alongside the relaunch of cooperation between the EU and the countries of the Middle East and North Africa (MENA), the partnership with the African Union (AU), and their inclusion in the agenda of the future European Geopolitical Community, within the perspective of a process of differentiated European integration, whose contours will emerge during the constituent phase to be launched with the next European parliamentary term.

All of this raises the issue of reforming global international organisations such as the United Nations and the World Trade Organization, where the European Union must make respect for the rule of law a central priority, as a non-negotiable value both internally and in its relations with third countries.

Promoting the establishment of an international forum capable of renewing the foundations of peace and restoring dignity to a framework of security and cooperation, modelled on the example of the 1975 Helsinki Conference, is a primary responsibility of the European Union. It is also an essential component of its strategic autonomy, within the framework of a single foreign and security policy, of which a common defence must ultimately form an integral part.



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Anatomy of a Conflict: Architecture of a Solution.

An Israeli-Palestinian Partnership Towards Levantine Federalism

by Hili Emanuel and Yair Gorni

The "Al-Aqsa Flood" attack on October 7, 2023, did not just breach a border; it unleashed a global shockwave. The physical conflict was transmitted constantly to social media, creating an overwhelming sense of real-time presence and turning global users into mobilized witnesses. A new kind of war erupted—a **glocal war**—where soft power weaponized narratives, transforming the Levant into the epicenter of a global ideological battle. Thus, the traditional one-way nature of proxy warfare became bidirectional – everyone is affected. This shift harbors both opportunity and danger.

The opportunity. Global pressure shatters the illusory status quo, forcing a reckoning and compelling both peoples to confront questions suppressed for decades.

The danger of repetition. As the window narrows, soft power imports foreign narratives ill-suited to our context, belonging to same failed power structures: the imposition of "One State" or "Two States" solutions. Under these binary paradigms, Israelis and Palestinians remain trapped in a chronicle of foretold failure that has lasted nearly a century. But within this dialectic lies potential for healing: The global dynamic can force us to formulate an authentic solution, and only an internal initiative can bring about real change. Just as post-war Europe chose integration over recurring conflict, we too can choose differently.

The Paradox. Israelis and Palestinians are locked in a paradox: they cannot separate, yet they cannot unite. The classic two state solution is inherently detached from the facts on the ground and therefore have consistently failed. As for one-state idea; the cases of Lebanon and Cyprus (a "frozen conflict") demonstrate that without a federal structure, ethno-religious divisions within a unitary state led to paralysis or civil war. This paradox traps both sides in a Zero-Sum Game: if one side "wins" according to its narrative terms, the other necessarily loses its national self-determination.

The Trap: "Anti-Dialogue", Direct dialogue is precluded by two factors: an asymmetric power balance that sabotages equality, and the inability to experience the other as a real subject. The parties are trapped in a structural limbo of "Anti-Dialogue": Each side is convinced of its own righteousness and the other's intent to destroy them, and mutual dehumanization is being institutionalized. Therefore, even when external circumstances force an agreement, it is viewed as a temporary compromise, guaranteeing the perpetuation of the conflict.

The Status Quo: Conflict Economies. The conflict drove the evolution of organizational and institutional structures in both communities, establishing a self-serving logic that mandates a "managed conflict." Complementary conflict economies took shape: in Israel, a war-based ecosystem where military exports legitimize control over West Bank; among Palestinians, an aid-and resistance/terror-based ecosystem deepened dependency while victimhood narratives justified resistance/terrorist acts.

Internationally, the conflict became embedded in a broader "conflict industry." It was exploited as a proxy battlefield where major powers supply arms and aid, and regional actors leverage their relationship—or non-relationship—with Israel as a bargaining chip. This mechanism was appropriated by polarized narratives—from the 'leftist' "settler colonialism" to the 'rightist' "clash of civilizations". This global system proves the structural trap: institutional survival is optimized around the *process* of resolution rather than the solution itself. Even those with the purest intentions are entrapped in this paradox, consuming the "need for a solution" as a product rather than achieving it.

A Moment Before - Beyond Separation or Unity. Before the conflict took root, shared life in the Levantine space was not perceived as impossible. Figures like Martin Buber, Esther Moyal, Fayez Bey al-Idrisi, and Musa al-Alami actively promoted shared political frameworks. However, the increasing frequency of violence, peaking in 1948, created conditions in which these ideas were perceived as naive. Consequently, the brave ones who chose to walk together were dropped from the canon of the national ethos, and the evidence of shared life was expelled from memory.

Hannah Arendt argued that life conditions shape thoughts, not the reverse. Accepting her premise, we formulate the political question: What are the necessary conditions to enable such visions? Change requires a paradigm shift that liberates us from the identity trap—from sovereign nation-states to *Levantine federalism*.

Towards Levantine Federalism: The Paradigm Shift. This paradigm shift rests on a radical inversion: transforming the Israeli-Palestinian relationship from a global symbol of polarization—fueling the "soft power" war—into a unifying regional force. By proving that distinct identities can flourish within a shared framework, we do not only stabilize the Levant; we offer a new global resonance—a testament to the possibility of harmony between differences.

Prerequisites for Progress: Structural Imperatives. To operationalize this shift and succeed where traditional models failed, the architecture adheres to three structural imperatives:

1. *A Joint Political-Civil Front:* Bypassing structurally paralyzed leaderships by generating the solution through a shared coalition, actively dismantling institutionalized dehumanization.
2. *Sovereignty via Integration:* Constructing Palestinian statehood **through** participation in regional mechanisms rather than bilateral "gifting," making integration the engine of independence.
3. *Immediate Multilateralism:* Shifting from a fragile bilateral dynamic to a robust regional framework to dismantle the zero-sum economy and withstand proxy pressures.

Stage One: Regional Integration. The first stage aims to create a "proof of concept" for a shared future. Models of "functional federalism"—such as ASEAN and the former ECSC—demonstrate how states can retain sovereignty while coordinating resources for mutual gain.

Paradoxically, extensive regional cooperation already exists (water, energy, trade) but is suppressed by the Anti-Dialogue; it is kept "under the table," hidden from the public, and viewed as a tactical concession. This proves the failure is institutional. Therefore, the solution must be structural: the immediate establishment of a Multilateral Southern Levantine Framework (Israel, Palestine, Lebanon, and Jordan).

Within this structure, Palestinian sovereignty is established functionally in a way that breaks the cycle of dependency while receiving practical support for independence, first through expanded autonomy (area A) over most of the West Bank and all of Gaza, followed by a peace agreement establishing an operational platform for active participation in the regional grid.

Operationalizing the Paradigm Shift. This shift requires concrete incentives to cement a unique Israeli-Palestinian partnership. A Joint Entry into the Greater Arab Free Trade Area (GAFTA) could deliver that. Israel gains regional legitimacy and major market access; Palestinians gain equal regional status, economic integration, and reinforcement for a stable, sovereign state-building process. Supported by a Joint Education Council and Freedom of Movement, this trajectory does more than connect infrastructure; by transforming the Levant into an autonomous, thriving economic hub, it neutralizes the influence of external financial incentives, liberating the region from dependency and restoring Levantine pride.

Stage Two: The Founding of a Southern-Levantine Confederation As trust deepens, the core partners—Israel and Palestine—followed by —Jordan and Lebanon—institutionalize their relationship into a confederal arrangement. Similar to the EU, sovereignty remains with each state, while shared institutions manage the economic union and a joint administrative regime for Jerusalem. With prosperity comes the need to defend it. Security cooperation evolves into a Joint Frontier Force,

securing borders against proxy destabilization. Moreover, shared responsibility strengthens psychological trust; defending what we built together transforms the relationship from dependency into partnership and, ultimately, friendship. Citizens remain nationals of their states but participate in shared governance through a Levantine Parliament. Jerusalem becomes the Confederation's capital—open to all, with free access to holy sites—serving as the beating heart of the entire Levant.

Stage Three: The Levantine Federation. When conditions for full co-existence ripen, the Confederation evolves into a full Levantine Federation. This is the phase of completion: stabilizing and integrating Syria and Iraq, restoring the Levant to its historical role as a cohesive bridge. In this model, inspired by Switzerland and Belgium, authority is shared: Defense and diplomacy become federal responsibilities, while culture and education remain local. This ensures that distinct groups can thrive without erasing identity. Arabic, Hebrew, Aramaic, Circassian, and Kurdish will be recognized as the languages of the Federation—reclaiming the region's rich, shared heritage.

The Possibility of Friendship – Beyond the Horizon. The threat of another externally forced partition agreement is knocking on our doorstep yet again, and its predetermined failure makes further escalation inevitable. Faced by the magnitude of the hour, we—Palestinians and Israelis—broke the boundaries of the Anti-Dialogue. We joined hands with the Young European Federalists (JEF) on the island of Ventotene, where the European Federalist Manifesto was born. On the island, surrounded by water, JEF provided us with the theoretical and organizational tools to reimagine our future together. During this direct dialogue, traumas surfaced, fears struck, and distrust rocked our boat while tensions exploded. But we transcended them all, not by forcing one to succumb to the other's narrative but by daring to dream, turning together to face a new horizon.

Our dialogue didn't try to compromise between competing narratives, but to understand the structural conditions that need to ripen so new stories could be realized. From this understanding, we drew a declaration for a future shared federalist union.

You may say that we are dreamers, but we are not the only ones. Join us.



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WHEN GLOBAL CITIZENS AWAKEN

An opportunity for global federalism.

From the beginning and again and again

by Christoph J. Rohland

From the beginning and again and again. In the end, humans emerged from evolution. We have no scientific explanation as to why he was born or should live. His existence seems to be a coincidence. Or is it? Over the millennia, we have learned, sometimes better, sometimes worse, that we are not alone on this planet. Cultures, homeland, societies and personal circumstances have shaped us and we have learned from them, and are currently learning again, that we are not only dependent on each other, but also strongly dependent on each other.

At the beginning of the world, people from all continents were born with equal rights and dignity. During our personal development, we matured from subjects to citizens. This results in locations of the branch, affiliation, rights and obligations. A survey in 59 countries has shown that 70% identify as "global citizens" with an increasing tendency. Humanity is often referred to as one big "one family". The question remains: How do we, as individuals or as part of the big family, deal with other people in other societies, in other families?

Historically, history has shown many models of coexistence and a wide variety of people have had a wide variety of experiences in the world in the course of their lives.

Challenges as opportunities. Every inhabitant of the earth has grown into a citizen of the world by participating in living together with others. A citizen of the world, truly grown into the "unique" of his kind and ancestry. There is only him as an individual, whether he wanted to, sought it or not; He was never asked about this. He is there now and will be forced by the social systems to take a personal path in life and to take responsibility for his existence. Over the years, his behaviour will betray his innermost being: either he rules himself or he is governed.

This is the fate of every citizen of the world and the beginning of a personal tightrope walk through the years of his life. Since early times, people had repeatedly agreed on forms of government that they judged to be sensible and just; Many world citizens had recognized that dictatorial governments do not lead to the ideal form of government, precisely because they do not include this indispensable component of sustainable connection to all world citizens.

The exclusionary *imperialism* and *patriotism* of a few powerful people led to *National Socialism* in Germany. This was anything but social, because it was exclusively reserved for a few, which did not promote increased social cooperation among the people and led to *oligarchy* and *authoritarianism*. More and more, all forces were oriented towards the global capital market, which led to the *plutarchy*.

We global citizens can balance these recurring political currents by staying together as like-minded people. To withstand the pressure of the extreme singular parties and network worldwide. This can only be achieved by a *democracy* through laws and co-determination of all citizens. The *plutarchy* is afraid of democracy, of all movements in general, when power is shared and global control is lost. Supranational federalism is a permanent thorn in the side of the plutarchy. When world citizens rebel against governments with the courage to act and openly vent their displeasure, this is a signal of political oppression in the country. On the other hand, it is the best sign that in this country citizens of the street have developed a

social sympathy and are working together for a change of system. History shows that our will for peace and justice is unbroken. A kind of "global identity" has emerged. Global citizens want to create understanding, protection and security and promote knowledge and education. Boutros Ghali, former UN Secretary of State, said:

"We must promote the democratization of globalization before globalization destroys the foundations of democracy."

In order for every citizen to be able to stop the destructive downward spiral in world affairs, revolutionary-ordered measures must be taken. International law is currently being trampled on again by egoists of the plutarchy in the East and in the West. If these ruling minorities should one day turn away from their arbitrary forms of government and selfishness, then *democracy can* expand further. Democratic states had multiplied again and again worldwide in three cycles from 1900, then from 1940 and 1980, are now stagnating and in some cases are also declining. But in a survey of 100 countries between 2005-2022, 90 percent of respondents thought democracy was important. Citizens of the world seem to awaken and strengthen themselves in individual actions and joint action.

Even democracy cannot exclude real influences of imperialism, patriotism, national socialism, oligarchy, authoritarianism and plutarchy, but if properly applied and enshrined in law, all citizens are called upon to vote in a democracy. So that the result is capable of winning a majority and untouchable for too loud minorities.

Global Order and Regional Autonomy. For today's world with almost 9 billion inhabitants, we will completely turn our political ideas from the last centuries upside down. Not because we have to, but because, due to the global imbalance of our planet, we have agreed that the old material value system is unsuitable for the 21st century, downright harmful; wars, health, resources and the geopolitical order have become a heavy burden worldwide. The call for strong reforms is getting louder and louder. The opinion that world citizens can leave global order to politics or the economy alone is unfortunately widespread and wrong. On the contrary, an in-depth analysis of our worldview shows that neither politics nor business has the strength and competence to create sustainable renewals for a community; Both forces fail because they are both not heard globally and are too insignificant regionally to bring about imminent changes. There is a lack of power from the middle class. There is a lack of global citizens.

It is in the nature of our thinking that we often come out as socially just and participatory. But when it comes to making decisions or taking responsibility, we like to become ego-world citizens again and like to leave the actions to the state, the powerful or responsible parties.

It can't go on like this. Citizens of the world must not leave governance to political minorities who pursue their own interests and do not assume the damage caused. There are still too few global citizens who are committed to systemic change and reforms of the global world order. The karmic habits of the comforts of the last century lie too deep in us adults, when we still clung to unshakable growth and enjoyed inexhaustible resources. This misconception must be shaken and brought to a peaceful new beginning. More desires can still be won with power, money and egocentricity than with cooperation, listening, devotion and sharing. But course corrections require global movement. Exactly, that is perhaps the only thing that every citizen of the world possesses: perseverance, will and strength, mixed with trust, hope and faith. It is these global citizens who mobilize movements, no one else.

Unfortunately, little is done with writing books and reports, participating in protest parades, donating money, restricting one's own mobility, reducing one's personal ecological footprint, saving energy and praying.

No, it's first of all about questioning your own little world:

What do I personally and indispensable need for good survival?

Why am I attached to objects, to my possessions?

Which material can I get rid of and how?

How great is my personal willingness to make sacrifices?

What am I doing for other global citizens?
Where can I find strength and support?

Admittedly, the essential: *One World Council for Environmental Protection* can only be implemented when the world citizens of all countries have found answers and solutions to such questions.

International movements such as ATLAS, WFM or DWB still show far too little power for dialogue with world citizens, however they are useful in promoting global federalism.

Further room for manoeuvre. And we can do much more to get involved in the local, national and global world order as global citizens: for example, by voting when we are asked to do so. Besides, what do you think of the establishment of a citizens' assembly in your municipality? There are now citizens' assemblies in over 30 countries. They are not a substitute for elected parliaments, but a political complement. Try to support revolutionary ideas benevolently, even if there is a risk of destabilizing the current system. Inaction would be the greater evil, which could also happen. Finally, we can also increasingly reach out to other global citizens, actively listen and learn from each other, develop curiosity for the unknown and create structures for future institutions.

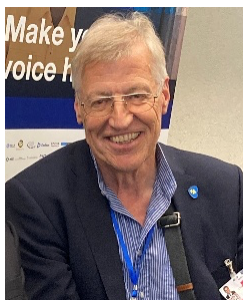
What remains. Imperialism, patriotism, national socialism, oligarchy, authoritarianism and plutarchy are outdated forms of government that are no longer capable to guide governments and must therefore be ended. Global citizen engagement, whether large or small, must find its way into global politics, because it helps to reduce power imbalances.

There is still no clear vision or leadership that could advance a "New World Order." That is why every attempt to enter one's own scope of action and try out actions is so important and right.

Every action counts! If we stay informed (knowledge is power). Act collectively (together we are stronger) and consistent (long-term pressure leads to change), then nothing stands in the way of an orderly change of system.

It seems to be confirmed that for the imminent globalization of federalism, the countless and perhaps still unknown citizens of the world, i.e. you and me, must first and foremost be found, so that the dilemma of the 21st century between global order and regional autonomy is solved once and for all.

It seems to be that for the imminent globalization of federalism, the countless and perhaps still unknown citizens of the world, i.e. you and me, must first and foremost be found, so that the dilemma of the 21st century between global order and regional autonomy is solved once and for all.



Christoph J. Rohland-Oeri, humanistic and commercial trained, emigrated abroad for language and professional years. Shaken up by reports from the Club of Rome, he travelled through South America and proved forms of life in Brazil, Paraguay and Chile. Finally, in Argentine Patagonia he found his new home. After 3 years the war in Falkland Islands compelled him to return to Switzerland, where he managed most of time retail business and personnel consulting. Today he is an environmental activist and works on climate-solutions and politics.
